

Sean Finch

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Education

Northeastern University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Music

September 2023 – May 2027

Boston, MA

Relevant Courses: Systems Security, Security of Wireless & Mobile Systems, Network Fundamentals, Network Security, Database Design, Cyberlaw, Operating Systems, Software Engineering, Intro to CS Research, Science Technology & Public Policy, Object-Oriented Design

Leadership & Activities: CTF Club, NU Choral Society (President), Alpha Phi Omega Co-ed Community Service Fraternity (President, Standards Chair, Service Committee), Cheese Club, NU Outdoors Club, Oasis Coding Club

Experience

Palo Alto Networks

Security Engineer Intern

June 2026 – September 2026

Santa Clara, CA

- Owned end-to-end design and implementation of Application Control Posture Check, a novel internal DAST tool that scans apps against GRC controls, cutting manual review time from 3 hrs to a 5-min automated scan; demoed at a local OWASP chapter
- Built the scanning engine in Python, provisioning containers via Terraform to run compliance check across apps in parallel
- Automated 16 GRC controls (NIST CSF) across 10+ apps, replacing one-time onboarding checks with continuous daily scans
- Built both ends of the risk dashboard data flow: a pipeline pushing scan findings into BigQuery, and a Django REST API the dashboard queries to pull them back, giving the CISO and Board live security posture and control-drift visibility
- Architected and coded the risk dashboard's first RBAC system, giving each InfoSec team least-privilege access to its own data

Neuralink

Systems Engineer Intern (Security Operations)

April 2026 – June 2026

Fremont, CA

- Overhauled endpoint, identity, and cloud security during rapid growth, earning executive buy-in for a dedicated security team
- Tested and deployed Microsoft Defender XDR and Sentinel (SIEM) across 500+ endpoints for alerting and incident response
- Managed the Intune MDM fleet across macOS and Windows, aligning device baselines to CIS Benchmarks and enforcing Conditional Access lockdowns, registration, and OS update rings that moved 20%+ of devices off outdated versions
- Automated provisioning with 10+ Terraform modules and attribute-based Entra dynamic groups, auto-assigning 500+ users

Audax Group

IT Operations Co-op (Security Operations)

May 2025 – April 2026

Boston, MA

- Ran Nessus scans and vetted apps (permissions, network, posture), remediating findings and blocking risky software
- Hardened 700+ endpoints via configuration baselines in Entra ID aligned to CIS Benchmarks, boosting compliance by 35%
- Automated Autopilot provisioning (PowerShell scripts, Intune Win32), cutting imaging time 20%; briefed executives on impact

CENIC

Cybersecurity Intern

May 2024 – August 2024

La Mirada, CA

- Ran ~5 DDoS analyses/week on CalREN, safeguarding 20M+ students across all 12K+ public schools incl. CSU/UC systems
- Operated Tenable Nessus and Qualys vulnerability detection systems, using Python to automate scans and cut review time 50%
- Documented security processes and gathered KPI metrics, demonstrating improvements in response times and overall posture

Projects

Homelab Infrastructure | *TrueNAS SCALE, RAIDZ1, Proxmox, Kubernetes, Docker, Nginx*

- Built and maintain a production-grade home server on TrueNAS and Kubernetes, self-hosting 15+ services for 10+ users
- Deployed Wazuh agents for security logging, alerting; used OpenVAS to scan 15+ services and 15+ endpoints for exposure

Port Scanner | *Python*

- Built a concurrent Python port scanner that enumerated 25+ lab hosts, cut manual port checks from 2+ hours to a few minutes
- Added banner grabbing and JSON output to surface exposed services and make results easy to review or extend

Attack Surface Mapper | *Go*

- Built a Go attack-surface mapper that discovered 20+ subdomains, 30+ live hosts, and 100+ open ports across a lab target set
- Added concurrent probing, banner grabbing, and TLS checks to flag 10+ exposures across 25+ lab targets and output JSON daily

Technical Skills

- Cybersecurity & Technologies:** Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Sentinel, Tenable Nessus, Qualys, OpenVAS, Elastic SIEM, Kibana, Wazuh, Wireshark, Burp Suite, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Benchmark, NIST CSF
- Identity & Infrastructure:** Okta, Entra ID, Active Directory, Intune, Terraform, GCP/BigQuery, Kubernetes, Docker, Nginx, Caddy, REST APIs, Git, Tailscale, Proxmox, TrueNAS SCALE, Linux
- Languages & Development:** Python, Go, Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, React.js, Node.js, Powershell, Bash, SQL, C++, C

Interests

Street Photography, Car Culture, Mountain Biking, Backpacking, Choral Singing, Weight Training, Video Games, Romanian Culture